

FOR PRINCIPALS & SUPERINTENDENTS · 3-MINUTE READ

Prompting Basics: Getting Useful Results Every Time

A 45–60 minute, self-facilitated session that turns AI access into AI skill, and leaves your school with a growing shared prompt library. Run by your own coach or teacher-leader; no consultant required.

Why this matters now

The 2025 Gallup survey of 2,232 teachers found that weekly AI users save about 5.9 hours a week, roughly six weeks a year, while 40% of teachers don't use AI at all. Access is identical; skill is not. Prompting is the learnable skill that closes that gap, and researchers who tested structured prompts against casual ones measured response-quality gains of about 58% on their own benchmark. This session teaches the skill in one hour and installs the habit system that keeps it growing.

What your staff will be able to do afterward

- Write four-part prompts (role · task · context · format) instead of vague requests
- Apply the "colleague test" before submitting any prompt
- Iterate deliberately: content, voice, details, instead of settling for first drafts
- Own one reusable prompt template for a weekly task, built during the session
- Contribute to a shared staff prompt library that compounds all year
- State what prompting can't fix: verification and judgment stay human

Research base in brief

Skill gap & time savings: Gallup–Walton Family Foundation (2025) · Prompt structure evidence: Bsharat et al. (2024, preprint); White et al., PLoP (2023) · Practice frameworks: OpenAI, Anthropic, and Google official guidance; NC Dept. of Public Instruction CRAFT framework (2024); AI for Education Five-S model · Adoption context: RAND RR-A134-25 (2025). Full APA citations ship in the kit's References file.

Where it fits

Kit 2 of 8 in **Track A: AI Foundations**, after Kit 1 establishes the safety rules. Ships with a 30-day plan (three 10-minute PLC follow-ups that grow the prompt library, no new meetings) and an exit ticket that doubles as PD documentation. Zero student data anywhere: the skills are practiced on teacher tasks only.

The compounding asset: most PD evaporates; this session leaves a shared prompt library that gets more valuable every week your staff uses it. By Kit 18 it becomes a formal, organized collection.

Built by Adam & Katelyn Spinozzi, a husband-and-wife team of certified educators with over 20 combined years in the classroom (CTE Carpentry; K-8). © AI-Ready School. Informational, not legal advice; consult district counsel before adopting policy. Check with your district or state whether this PD qualifies for local credit.